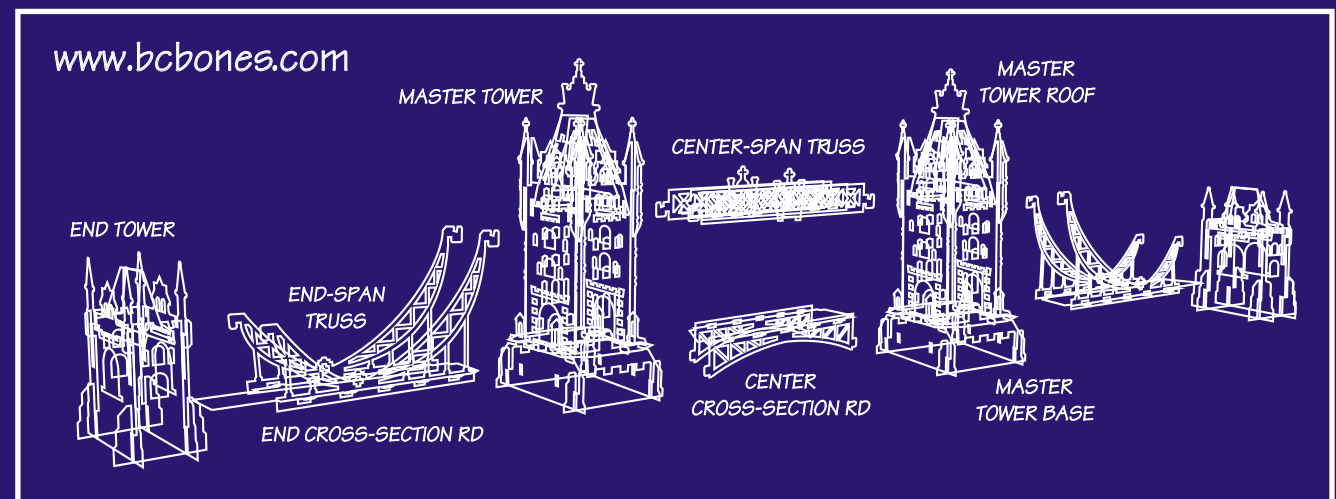
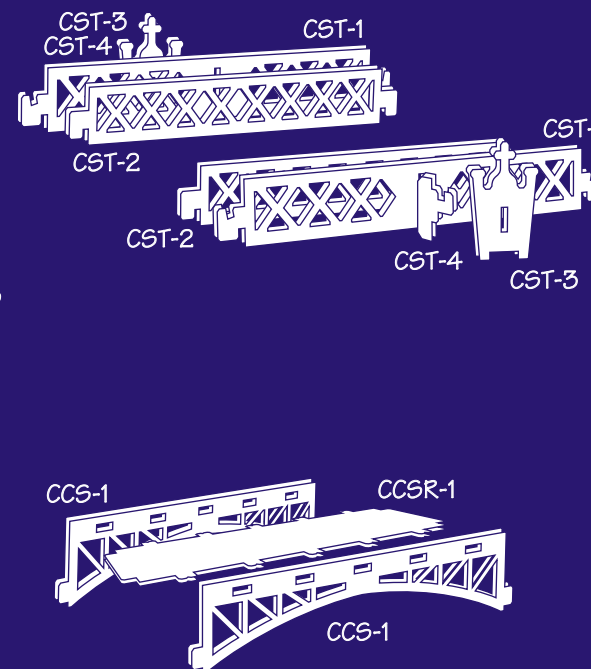
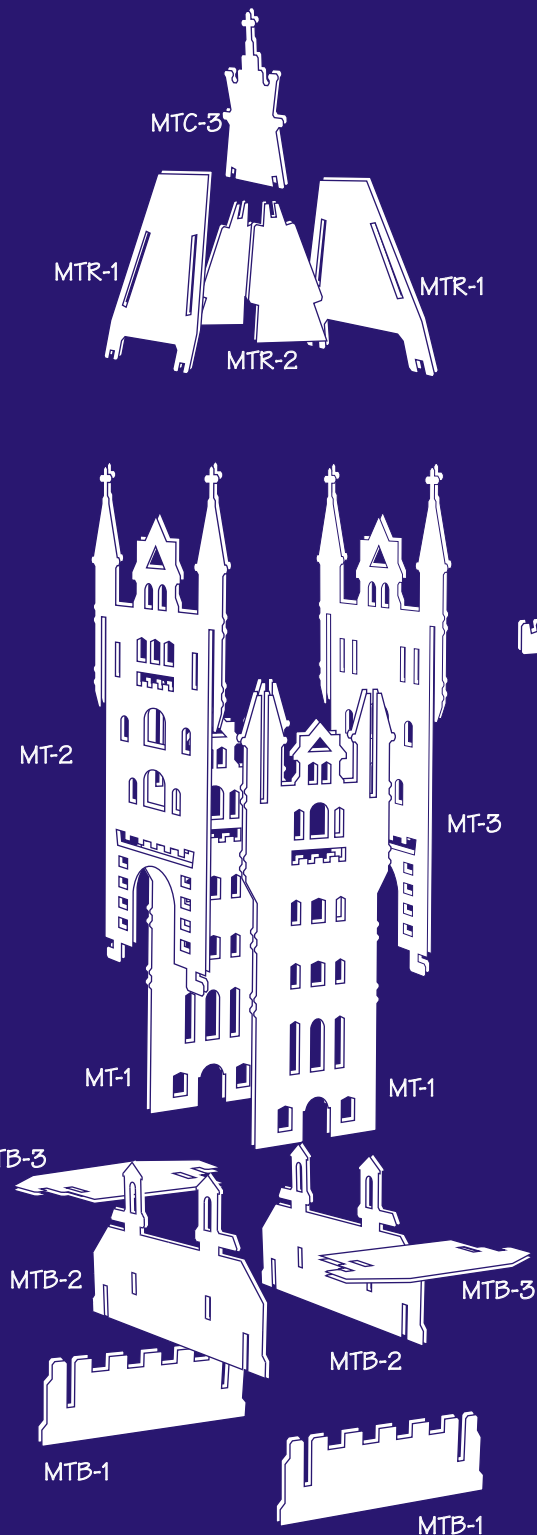
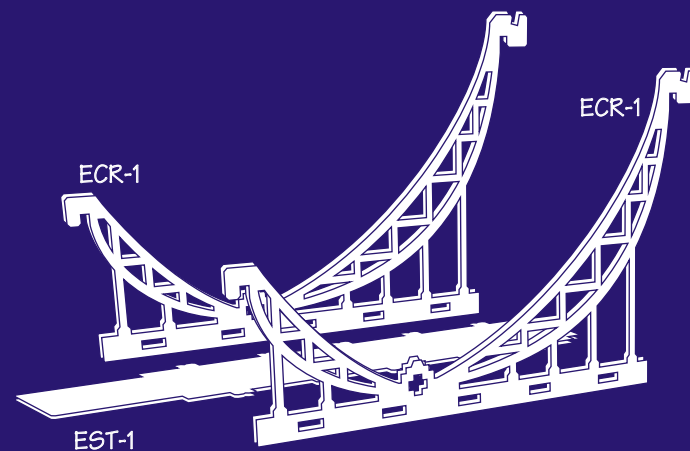
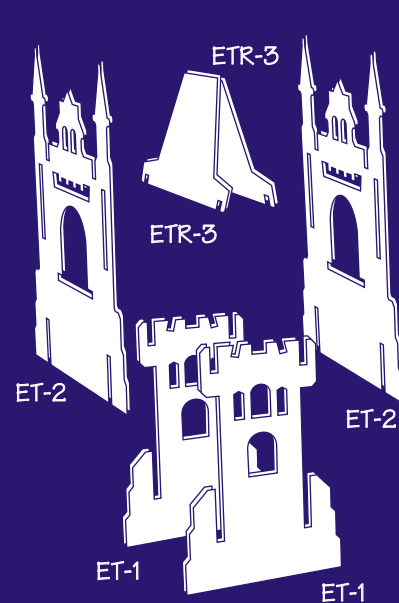
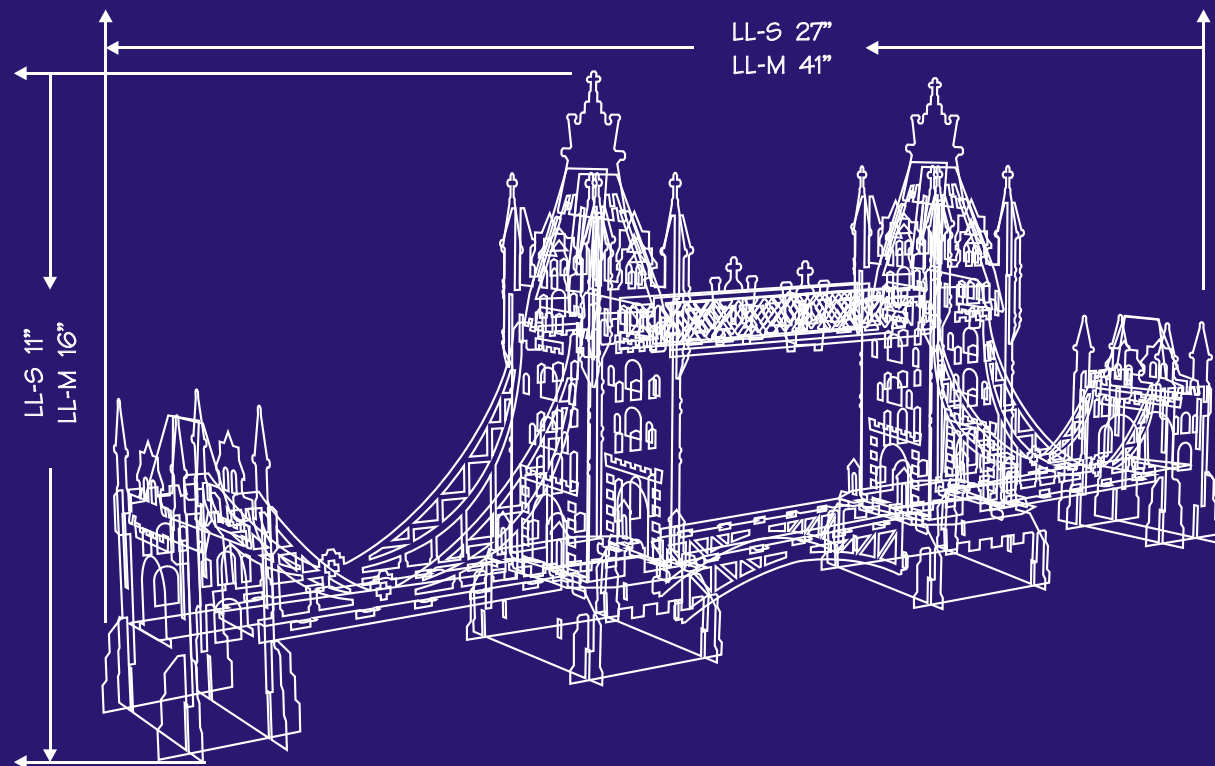


LONDON TOWER BRIDGE



FACT FILE:

London Tower Bridge was completed in 1894. It took 8 years, 5 major contractors and the relentless labor of 432 construction workers to build Tower Bridge. Over 50 designs were put forward for consideration. It wasn't until October 1884 that Horace Jones, the City Architect, in collaboration with John Wolfe Barry, offered the chosen design for Tower Bridge.

Two massive piers had to be sunk into the river bed to support the Construction and over 11,000 tons of steel provided the framework for the towers and walkways. This was then clad in Cornish granite and Portland stone, both to protect the underlying steelwork and to give the bridge a more pleasing appearance.

When it was built, Tower Bridge was the largest and most sophisticated bascule bridge ever built ("bascule" comes from the French for "see-saw"). It was a hydraulically operated bridge, using steam to power the enormous pumping engines. The energy created was then stored in six massive accumulators so that, as soon as power was required to lift the bridge, it was readily available. The accumulators fed the driving engines, which drove the bascules up and down. Despite the complexity of the system, the bascules only took about a minute to raise to their maximum 86 degrees.

Nowadays, the bascules are still operated by hydraulic power, but since 1976 they have been driven by oil and electricity rather than by steam.

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LONDON TOWER BRIDGE

LONDON, ENGLAND 1894

PROJECT REPORT OF CHIEF ENGINEER

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LONDON TOWER BRIDGE PARTS LIST (TOTAL NUMBER OF PARTS 59)

MASTER TOWERS.....(4)MT-1 (2)MT-2 (2)MT-3
MASTER TOWERS BASE..... (4)MTB-1 (4)MTB-2 (4)MTB-3.
MASTER TOWERS ROOF.....(4)MTR-1 (4)MTR-2 (2)MTC-3
CENTER CROSS-SECTION RD.....(2)CCS-1 (1)CCSR-1

CENTER SPAN TRUSS.....(2)CST-1 (2)CST-2 (2)CST-3 (2)CST-4
END TOWERS.....(4)ET-1 (4)ET-2 (4)ETR-3
END CROSS-SECTION RD..... (4)ECR-1
END SPAN TRUSS.....(2)EST-1

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